

Tips & tricks

Looking for ways to stay completely anonymous while browsing online? We'll show you the way

**Drones deliver pills**

Activists in Northern Ireland used a drone to deliver abortion pills. <http://digit.in/DrnDlrvy>

Linux for all, weird SMPS, and the ever-popular SLI question

From simple fixes to expensive replacements – our readers have problems and we have solutions.

Hidden Networks

I am connected to the Internet via a Wi-Fi router. I need to make it visible to only my pc. Other people keep trying to access my Wi-Fi. So please tell me a solution to make the Wi-Fi connection only visible to my PC. My Wi-Fi router is TP-Link.

–Avinash Sharma

A What you've asked is one of the most basic steps that anyone should perform while setting up a Wi-Fi network – hiding the SSID. The make of your router doesn't



Hide your SSID

matter since this is a very basic feature that is present in all devices. Simply login to your router using the pre-defined IP address, provided you haven't changed it. It's usually 192.168.1.1 and the user ID and password are both usually "admin", and in some cases the password might be "password". Once you're logged in, you can navigate to the Wireless tab and right there in the basic settings you'll see the options "Enable Wireless" and "Hide SSID Broadcast". Ensure that both these options are checked. Click on Save/Apply and you're all set. Some settings might require you to reboot the router but that's pretty much all there is to it. Next time onwards whenever you try to connect to your router, you will have to manually enter the SSID as your router will no longer be listed among the visible IDs.

You'll have to go with "Connect to a Hidden Network" and then proceed with the WPA/WPA2 key for authentication.

Starting with Linux

I am very interested in programming and Linux and so thought about setting my own Linux machine using my old PC. Here are the specifications:

- **CPU:** Intel Pentium 4 Single Core - 2.66GHz
- **RAM:** 2 GB
- **HDD:** 180 GB including Windows

Partition + 1 TB external for storing important Files and extra software backup.

I had set up an Arch Linux installation but due to slow internet connection I removed it and thought about Ubuntu since we have an software server cache which is quite fast (about 5 MBps). So the main requirement of this OS will be Programming. The

secondary objective is for it to be easy for my parents to use basic services such as internet and Skype as they have absolutely no tech knowledge.

I was thinking Kubuntu since it is very Windows-like but I think it will take my resources while coding. Do you think I can install a tilting windows manager such that it won't cause the default KDE to act weird and it should only work in my session.

Also can you point me to some powerful and lightweight IDE, I used Geany in windows but I didn't like its interface but if I can change its theme in Linux then I will be happy. I am learning Python and would later want to learn C/C++ and Java.

–Asbin Dahal

A There are a couple of questions here so we'll tackle them one by one:

- 1) **Recommended OS:** We wouldn't recommend Arch. If you want a more windows-like UI, you should also consider Lubuntu which uses LXDE. The successor to LXDE, LXQt is also a great lightweight desktop environment. Alternatively we personally use openSuse and would recommend it, but it will suffer from the same issue of having slow download speeds. Kubuntu / Lubuntu is still fine though.
- 2) You can also add a separate desktop environment for coding. For instance we currently run KDE Plasma and also LXQt, icewm, and Openbox. We don't know about the default system used by Kubuntu / Ubuntu, but you can install LightDM or SDDM which allow you to pick which desktop environment you want to use while logging in. In this case you can use a tiling window manager separately. Plasma (KDE's desktop environment) allows you to select which window manager to use. So you can use a tiling window manager like Awesome with Plasma if you want. But 2GB RAM is a bit on the low side to be running Plasma 5.
- 3) **For IDE:** For Python we recommend Pycharm, it has a free open source version as well. But 2GB RAM might



Lubuntu - Windows-Like